OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass. All welcome

Accord Facilitators Needed Accord is inviting volunteers to train as facilitators for its **Marriage Preparation Programmes**, supporting couples preparing for the Sacrament of Marriage. Facilitators work as part of a small local team and help lead up to four programmes each year. Free professional training is provided. To find out more or apply: Tel: 01 505 3112 Email:marriagepreparation@accord.ie **Closing date for applications: 29 May 2026.** Please consider sharing your experience of marriage to support couples preparing for this important sacrament.

PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES flying from Derry 3rd July - 8th £935 Contact Siobhan 07871656780

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ALANON IT'S EASY TO SEE WHAT ALCOHOL IS DOING TO THE DRINKER BUT CAN YOU SEE WHAT IT IS DOING TO YOU? Are you afraid to upset someone for fear that it will set off a drinking bout? · For further information contact the Al Anon confidential helpline on 0800 0086 811 or email helpline@al-anonuk.org.uk . Alternatively, tel 028 9068 2368.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459
Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

PRIVACY NOTICE The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in Holy Family Church are available on line. Parishioners should note that the first 2 rows of seats are visible on line.

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH

Sun 26th April 2026

Vol. 44 No 17

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS
Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE
71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

WHOSE VOICE ?

In today's Gospel, Jesus speaks to us using the image of the shepherd and the sheep. It's a simple picture, but it carries a question that reaches right into our daily lives: *whose voice are we following?*

Because whether we notice it or not, we are always listening to something. The world around us is full of voices—telling us what matters, what success looks like, what will make us happy. Some of those voices promise a lot, but in the end, they leave us tired, anxious, or never quite satisfied. As Jesus says, *"the thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy."*

Then, in the middle of all that noise, there is another voice—the voice of the Shepherd.It is quieter, but it is steady. It does not confuse us or drive us; it **calls us by name**. And when we learn to recognize it, we begin to discover something important: that God is not distant. He knows us personally, and He desires to lead us.

And then we hear that promise at the heart of the Gospel: *"I came that they may have life, and have it abundantly."*
That is what God wants for us—not just to get by, not just to survive the week, but to live deeply and fully. A life rooted in His love. A life that has direction, even when things are uncertain. A life that carries peace, even in difficulty.

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Robert Barron, Bantry Road who died recently. May he rest in peace.

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time May McGrellis, Eileen Kelly, Kathleen O'Brien, James Kelly, Seamus Kelly, Dorothy Brown, Margaret McGilloway, Joan Curran, Colm Holmes, Patrick Quigley, Eileen Starrett, David Brinkley

READERS FOR MAY

6.00pm Vigil	Sister Ann	**9.3.0am**	Brenda Coyle
11am	Jackie Conway	**12.30pm**	Patricia Murphy

EUCHARISTIC MINISTERS MAY

VIGIL	William McGeehan Danny Kivelehan, Nipper Nicell
9.30am	Ann Daly
11.00am	Jacqueline McCarron, Neil Barr, Lynn Kelly
12.30pm	Christine Bonner, Majella Heaney Vivienne Morrison

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD The Fourth Sunday of Easter, also known as Good Shepherd Sunday, is a Day of Prayer for Vocations. We thank God for those He has called, and is calling, to diocesan priesthood, and we pray that many more will respond to that call to become spiritual guides and shepherds to the people of God in our time.

SUNDAY COLLECTION 19th April £2477.98 Standing Orders £400 and €216.52Thank you for your generosity

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET takes place Mon– Fri at 3pm in the church

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP on Thursday after 7.15pm Mass in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

TROCAIRE BOXES Please return Trocaire boxes as soon as possible.

A LAUDATO SI' MOVEMENT (LSM) Are you ready to help build a better world? Why not become a Laudato Si' Animator to bring prayer and action for climate justice together? This free online course begins on April 15th, and is available for all who are interested in exploring care for creation through the lens of faith and spirituality. Sign up at https://laudatosianimators.org'

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS is a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. The first event will be a talk on Thursday 30 April, at 7:30pm in our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by the Servant Sisters of Home of the Mother. It will be on the question, ***' Why be a Young Catholic in 2026'***, in which they will also reflect on the life of Sr. Clare Crockett. The talk will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments.

DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK SHRINE will take place on Saturday 6 June. In conjunction with the All Ireland Rosary Rally, we will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Eucharistic and Marian Shrine. For those for whom it is convenient, buses will leave St Eugene's Cathedral, at 8:00am: cost £50, which includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following the conclusion of the Mass in the Basilica. For further information, please contact Karen in the parish office at St Eugene's on 028 7126 2894 or by email at cathedral@derrydiocese.org.